The Ivory Cradle SCHOOL

The First Overnight Shift

Field reference and practice worksheet

01 Arrival handoff

Confirm the last feed and next feeding plan, the safe sleep space, when and how to wake a parent, the home address, and the pediatrician's after-hours number. Read back any unclear instructions.

02 Overnight essentials

Safe sleep. Place baby on their back in a separate, safety-approved crib, bassinet, portable crib, or play yard. Use a firm, flat, level surface with a fitted sheet only. [1]

Feeding. Start with clean hands and supplies. Use prepared formula within 2 hours of preparation and 1 hour of starting the feed. Discard leftovers. Warmed expressed breast milk has a 2-hour limit. Follow the CDC guidance for leftovers and storage. [2, 3]

Escalation. In the U.S., call 911 immediately for no breathing, unresponsiveness, severe trouble breathing, or blue/gray lips or face. For a newborn with a rectal temperature of 100.4°F (38°C) or higher, notify the parent immediately and contact the pediatrician or after-hours service right away for urgent evaluation. [4, 5]

03 Practice the handoff

The parents remember different last-feed times, 7:30 and 8:00 p.m. What would you ask before they go to bed?

Write a factual log entry. At 11:05 p.m., you offer 2 oz of formula. Baby takes 1.5 oz, has a wet diaper, and returns to the bassinet at 11:30 p.m.

Morning handoff: Lead with urgent concerns and follow-up, then recap the last feed and diaper, sleep, and who was contacted. Confirm the parent has taken over.

Sources: [1] AAP Safe Sleep · [2] CDC Formula Preparation · [3] CDC Breast Milk Storage · [4] AAP Fever and Your Baby · [5] AAP When to Call EMS

Practice with fictional details. Follow the baby's clinician-directed care plan for individualized instructions.